



EARTH'S CRUST



Just like you, Earth has a very thin skin. It is so thin that if you compare it to the whole Earth, it is thinner than the skin of an apple.

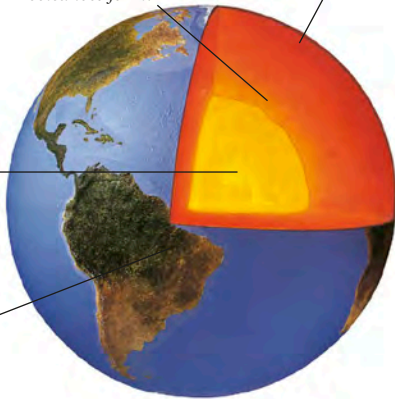
Earth's skin, or crust, is made up of rock, built up in layers over millions of years. The layers look like blankets on a bed, with lots of lumps and bumps in them.

The outer core is made of iron and nickel that have melted to form a liquid.

The inner core is a ball of iron and nickel. It is hotter here than at the outer core, but the ball stays solid.

The crust is a thin layer of rock between 3.7 and 43.5 miles (6 and 70 kilometers) thick.

The mantle is the layer below the crust. Parts of it are molten where volcanoes form.



How mountains are made

Many mountains are made when the Earth's crust is pushed up in big folds or forced up or down in blocks. The different shapes made are given different names.

Upfold

Downfold

Overfold

